

# Building a Metrics Dashboard for Search

*How a PM turns scattered data into a single source of truth — and drives search performance at an online travel company.*

PREPARED BY

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# A leading travel company, flying blind on search.

The Search team owns the most critical surface of the product — but they're making decisions without a clear view of how it actually performs.

## THE SITUATION

Data is manual, scattered, and slow. Decisions rely on anecdote, not evidence.

## THE PRESSURE

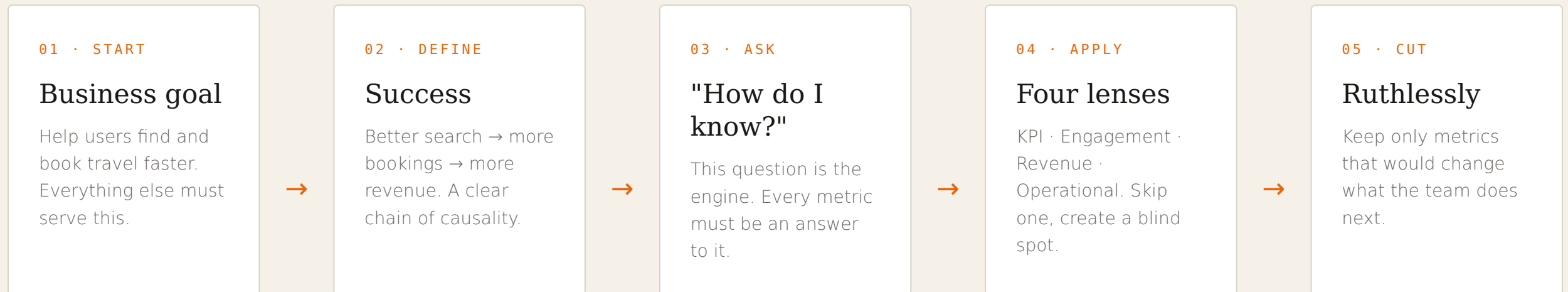
A working prototype must be presented to the Product Lead in one week.

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*The goal isn't to build a prettier spreadsheet — it's to make the right decision in five minutes, not five days.*

## THE CORE INSIGHT

# From business goal to dashboard, in six moves.



THE LITMUS TEST FOR EVERY METRIC

*"If this number moved, would I act differently?"*

# Four lenses for a complete picture.

## LENS 01

### Key Performance Indicators

*"Is search working overall?"*

The headline numbers that give a top-of-funnel view of search health.  
The north-star lives here.

## LENS 02

### User Engagement

*"How are users behaving inside search?"*

Behavioural signals — clicks, filters, sessions — that explain why KPIs move.

## LENS 03

### Revenue

*"Is search making money?"*

How effectively search converts user intent into bookings and commercial value.

## LENS 04

### Operational

*"Is the infrastructure stable?"*

Latency, uptime, errors — the technical foundation that everything else rests on.

# The five metrics Prerana tracks first.

01 · SEARCH VOLUME

4.2M

Queries per week. The baseline health signal —

02 · ZERO-RESULT RATE

6.2%

Searches returning nothing. High rate signals

03 · AVG. RESULTS/  
QUERY

42

Listings shown per search. Signals the right

04 · REFINEMENT RATE

19.7%

Users who re-search immediately. A quiet

NORTH STAR · 05

3.8%

Search-to-book rate. Every other KPI exists to explain movements

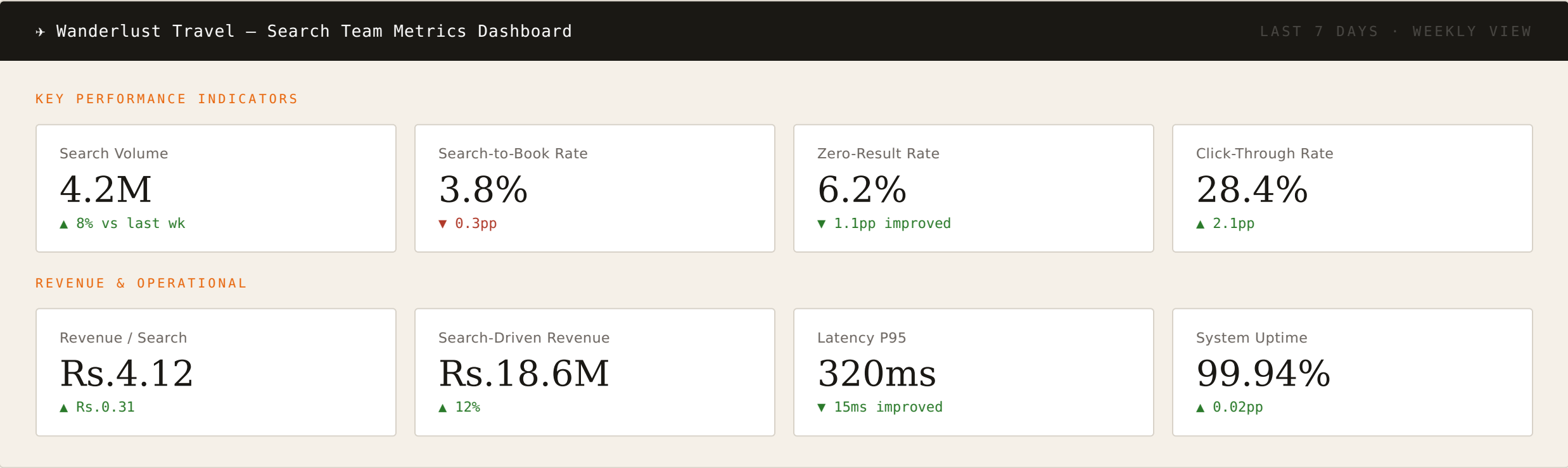
# Search health and user behaviour.

| METRIC                 | CATEGORY   | WHY IT MATTERS                                                                |
|------------------------|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Search-to-Book Rate    | KPI        | North-star conversion metric — did the search journey end in a booking?       |
| Zero-Result Rate       | KPI        | High rate signals inventory gaps or poor query parsing — a failed experience. |
| Avg. Results per Query | KPI        | Signals whether search surfaces the right breadth of relevant options.        |
| Click-Through Rate     | ENGAGEMENT | Measures result relevance and how attractive listings are to users.           |
| Filter Usage Rate      | ENGAGEMENT | Users actively refining intent — a sign of healthy, purposeful engagement.    |
| Search Refinement Rate | ENGAGEMENT | High rate quietly flags poor initial relevance — users keep re-searching.     |
| Mobile & Voice Share   | ENGAGEMENT | Directional signal showing where to invest next in the search experience.     |

# What search earns and how stable it stays.

| METRIC                 | CATEGORY    | WHY IT MATTERS                                                             |
|------------------------|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Revenue per Search     | REVENUE     | Efficiency metric linking every search query to the revenue it generates.  |
| Avg. Booking Value     | REVENUE     | Tracks revenue quality, segmented across flights, hotels, and packages.    |
| Upsell Attach Rate     | REVENUE     | Measures how well contextual recommendations drive add-on revenue.         |
| Cost per Acquisition   | REVENUE     | Efficiency of spend per booking — falls as search quality improves.        |
| Search Latency P95     | OPERATIONAL | Slow search directly drops click-through and conversion. Core SLA: <500ms. |
| System Uptime          | OPERATIONAL | Reliability metric — every minute of downtime is measurable lost revenue.  |
| Search Index Freshness | OPERATIONAL | Stale index means inaccurate pricing and availability shown to users.      |

# The prototype: one screen, the whole story.





# What this case study demonstrates.

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## 01 Metrics serve decisions, not dashboards.

The discipline isn't listing every measurable number — it's choosing the few that change what the team does next. Every metric earns its place by answering: "Would this change my action?"

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## 02 A four-lens framework prevents blind spots.

KPIs, engagement, revenue, and operational metrics each reveal something the others miss. Tracking revenue alone could hide a search experience that's silently failing real users.

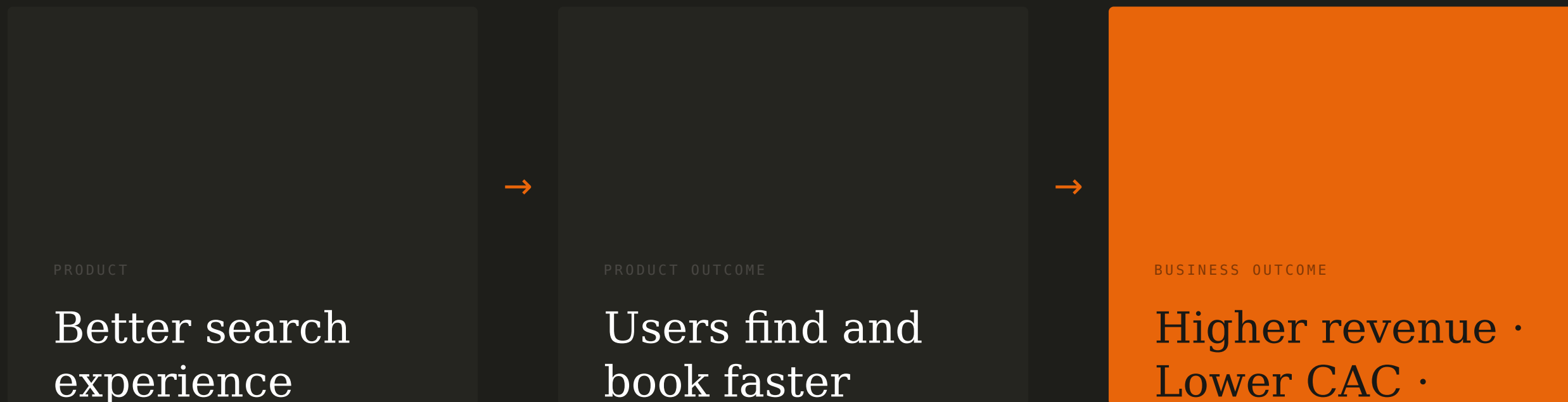
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## 03 A dashboard is a communication tool, not a data dump.

Arrangement matters as much as the data. Leading with the north-star metric and grouping by lens turns raw numbers into a story a leader can act on in under five minutes.

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# How better search pays off the business goal.



*Don't measure what's easy to track — measure what's hard to ignore.*

Happier  
customers

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